

LIBRARY AUTOMATION: SEATTLE PUBLIC LIBRARY

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Assignment 4, Part III

LIS 4050: Library & Information Technologies

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INTRODUCTION TO SPL (AMANDA)

- Metropolitan library system, established 1890
- Partnered with King County (KCLS) in 1943, reciprocal borrowing
- 7 other nearby library systems joined
- 755,000 pop., 2.3 million pop., 4+ million pop.
- 1.2 million annual visitors (central), 3.6 million (26 branches)
- 5.88 million physical books and other items loaned in 2024, 10+ million digital materials loaned
- Wide array of services and programs



BACKGROUND (AMANDA)

Technology Highlights from Needs Analysis: Retire old technology formats, elimination of outdated software, implement new ILS, and hire cybersecurity analyst

Current System Challenges:

- Outdated user interface, need modern features, been on Horizon ILS since 2004
- Need web-based solution
- Possibly also prefer SaaS
- Issues with software clients on staff PCs
- Security vulnerabilities (ransomware attack 2024)
- Hindered employee productivity
- Workflow disruptions

Objectives:

- Migration of ILS data off SPL's local servers
- Movement to a fully web-based, well-supported solution
- A shift to SaaS (Software as a Service) model
- Replacement for or integration with the BiblioCore discovery platform
- Requirement to follow current cybersecurity best practices
- Integrated support of current payment systems & third-party products
- Assistance with operational differences between member libraries

VENDOR QUALIFICATIONS (BETHANY)

The Seattle Public Library ask that qualified vendors to submit proposals in response to this RFP.

Vendors must show their ability to meet the requirements outlined in this section by providing detailed responses to the following qualifications:

• Provide Background and History of your company. Qualifications must include:

- Company name, address, and contact information
- Company establishment year and history
- Legal Structure (meaning LLC, Corporation, or sole proprietorship)
- Mission statement and values
- Essential staff that will be involved in this project

- Financial Health. This section must include audited financial statements from the past 3 years.
- Experience with Similar Projects. Qualifications must include:
 - A list of projects from the past 5 years with similar scopes.
 - References from 3 current or former clients, including those of public libraries.
 - Description of project challenges and how you overcame them.
- What Customer support options do you offer? Please list this as well as the following:
 - Customer support hours
 - Response times
 - Training programs provided for library staff.
 - If you offer manuals, FAQs, or video instructions.

COST SHEET

(A M A N D A)

Item	Unit Price	# Units	Total Price	Maintenance Price
ILS Database				
ILS Hosting				
ILS Software (breakdown per module if necessary)				
ILS OPAC (patron use), adjust if not applicable				
ILS Client Software (staff use)				
Reporting Software				
Testing Environment				
Functional				
Performance				
Security				
Customization Estimate				
Optional Modules and Services				
Self-Checkout				
Children's OPAC				
Website Hosting				
Print Management				
PC Reservation				
Room Reservation				
Events Calendar				
Delivery				
Installation				
Training				
Documentation				
Travel				
Per Diem				
Total System				

EVALUATION CRITERIA

(B L A K E)

- Complete RFP responses only
- 100 points maximum
- On-site demo:
 - 3 shortlisted vendors
 - Oral presentation with questions
 - Admin walkthrough
 - Final score awarded following presentation

Evaluation Criteria	Points
System Requirements: ILS satisfies system requirements as outlined under section “3. System Functionality Requirements”. ILS is expected to conform to existing SPL policies and will provide a smooth transition from current system.	40
Proposed Cost: System aligns with SPL budget and is itemized clearly under as required under section “5. Budget & Pricing”.	25
Vendor Qualifications: Vendor fulfills requirements as listed under section “4. Vendor Qualifications”. Vendor has also provided organizational reference chart outlining staffing needs, key personnel, and service providers as required for implementation of ILS. Personnel qualifications should also be given.	10
Maintenance: Vendor-provided plan for maintenance before, during, and following the implementation of the ILS fulfills technical support requirements as described. This plan must include whether any required training will be virtual or on-site. Plan must also offer an SaaS solution for technical support. Regular support may involve running reporting tasks, system configuration, and other general system operations.	8
Staff preference: Allocation for staff preferences following review of completed RFP response, on-site demonstration, preferences for technical features, and any additional vendor communications.	7
On-site Demonstration: Product demonstration is thorough, professional, and adequately addresses criteria as outlined above. SPL staff questions are answered clearly, and system administrators are given clear, direct walkthroughs of product features.	10





IMPLEMENTATION PLAN



TIMETABLE (AMANDA)

Event	Anticipated Date
Request for proposal issued	Wednesday, March 12, 2025
Last day for written questions	Friday, April 4, 2025
Request for proposal closes	Friday, April 11, 2025
Finalists on-site demos	4th week of May, 2025
Proposal evaluation completed	Friday, June 20, 2025
Negotiation of contract commences	Monday, July 7, 2025
Contract is signed	Friday, August 1, 2025
Acceptance	Within 6 months after signing contract



STAFFING (ASHLEY)

•Implementation Phase

- Project Manager: Oversees transition
- Systems Librarians: Configure & troubleshoot
- Data Migration Specialists: Transfer & validate records
- Cybersecurity Analyst: Ensure security & compliance
- Vendor Support: Assist with setup

•Training Phase

- System Administrators: Train staff
- Librarians & Supervisors: Learn system functions
- Paraprofessional Staff: Daily operations
- User Support: Patron assistance

•Ongoing Support

- Help Desk: Troubleshooting
- IT Team: Updates & security
- Trainers: Ongoing staff education

TRAINING (BLAKE)

- SPL retains training documents
- On-site vs virtual
 - Pre-, during, post-implementation
- System administrators first
 - ☐ Different departments
 - ☐ Supervisors next, etc.

Event	Deadline (from Acceptance)
System Administrators Training	Within 4 weeks
Librarians	Within 6 weeks
Supervisors	Within 10 weeks
Paraprofessional staff	Within 12 weeks



DATA MIGRATION PROCESS (ASHLEY)

ENSURING ACCURACY AND SECURITY

- **Extraction & Backup**
 - Retrieve records & create backups
- **Cleaning & Validation**
 - Remove duplicate, outdated, or corrupt data
- **Transformation**
 - Standardize to MARC21, BIBFRAME, RDA
- **Test Migration**
 - Sandbox testing for accuracy
- **Final Migration**
 - Low-traffic period for minimal disruption
- **Audit & Training**
 - Verify data & train staff

SYSTEM CUSTOMIZATION (BETHANY)

1. User Interface Customization

- Customizable search filters and catalog views for both users and staff.
- Incorporating branding logos, themes, and color schemes to align with SPL's overall brand.
- Accessibility compliance adjustments to support ADA standards.

2. Workflow and Automation

- Custom workflow creation for circulation, acquisitions, and user interactions.
- Automated notifications and alerts for overdue books, holds, and event reminders for staff and users.
- Role-based access to ensure appropriate permissions for different user groups.

3. Integration

- Seamless integration with SPL's existing catalog and databases.
- Compatibility with third-party vendors, including e-book providers, payment gateways, and interlibrary loan services.

4. Data Management & Reporting

- Customizable reports.
- Search and filtering options for data analysis.
- Secure data export functionality for further analysis and compliance reporting.

TESTING (BLAKE)

FOR A SMOOTH TRANSITION

- Product runs simultaneously (sandbox)
- Admin team
- Runs throughout training period
- Tests for:
 - Automation
 - Accessibility
 - Interoperability
- Ongoing alterations expected



GO-LIVE STRATEGY (ASHLEY)

Phased Rollout for a Smooth Transition

- **Parallel Testing:** New ILS runs with Horizon for comparison
- **Soft Launch:** Limited staff & user access, kiosk testing
- **Full Deployment:** Horizon retired, full system transition
- **Support & Monitoring:** 3-month evaluation, training, & final report

The background is a dark, textured surface with a network of light-colored nodes and lines, resembling a molecular structure or a data network. The nodes are small circles, and the lines are thin, connecting the nodes in a complex, web-like pattern. The overall effect is a subtle, scientific or technological aesthetic.

THANK YOU

Any questions?